

# DIGNITY

PROJECT 3  
2023



CLAUDIO GOBBER ART

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[www.claudiogobberart.com](http://www.claudiogobberart.com)



# Preface

We are delighted to present this new collection of portraits by talented emerging Italian artist Claudio Gobber. Inspired by the bold aesthetics of Pop Art and the intellectual exploration of Cubism, this continuing collection of portraits delves into the theme of Dignity, part of his ongoing artistic journey “The Art of Distilling Time” that will captivate, challenge, and ignite the Imagination.

Within these pages, you will discover a collection that showcases Gobber’s unique vision and exceptional talent. Using vibrant energy and multifaceted perspectives, these portraits embody the artist’s exploration of the theme of dignity as a core human right. Through this collection, viewers are invited to reflect on the painful and inspiring qualities that individuals and society produce in the face of poverty. An eternal struggle in our complex socioeconomic history that deeply affects us on a personal and societal level.

Combining elements of Pop Art and Cubism, he presents a body of work that is both visually striking and conceptually profound. His portraits provide a mirror to observe the subject from many perspectives. Capturing both the mutilation of dignity and its sustaining power in the face of material deprivation. The viewer is invited to consider victims and perpetrators in the same frame uniting both through our shared humanity.

This third collection is part of Gobber’s ongoing artistic mission “The Art of Distilling Time”. Where he aims to capture essential human aspects of the contemporary era. Each subsequent collection will delve into a different theme, offering a fresh and unique perspective that resonates with the artist’s evolving vision of modern humanity and how humans interact with the radically shifting reality they occupy. Through his art, the artist aims to engage viewers in a continuous dialogue, exploring a diverse range of subjects that are as dynamic and transformative as the world we inhabit.

His intention is not to dictate beliefs but to cultivate awareness of these crucial dialogues and inspire individuals to form their own considered viewpoints. Encouraging them to draw upon the wealth of knowledge at their disposal, to facilitate the development of meaningful and substantiated perspectives. This is as true for future generations as for current audiences, with his art serving as an anthropological time capsule for this rapidly changing society.



# Introduction

**In this collection,** the audience can delve into the theme of dignity as it intersects with human rights, exploring the historical and contemporary implications of poverty on both individuals and societies.

Human rights have clear intellectual and legal definitions. The classification and documentation of what constitutes these principles have been recorded by scholars, philosophers, and politicians for centuries. These fundamental principles to preserve the welfare of citizens of the world are the backbone of most nations and communities. However, it is dignity that emerges as the essence and the soul of human rights. Without this value, we lose respect, and worth, the true driving forces that sustain people and humanity.

Dignity is a constant dialogue between the owner and the bestower, created from within, but reinforced externally by our community and strangers. This powerful force has many benefits that can ripple across borders and generations when permitted. However, dignity like all humans is not infallible. It is not just theory, it is as much consciousness and emotion as it is intellectual principle, and it can be attacked, damaged and destroyed by invisible aggressors and self-sabotage.

Throughout history, one relentless adversary to human dignity has been poverty. From the stark inequalities of ancient civilizations to the Industrial Revolution's exploitation of the working class, the scars of poverty have been burned into the collective consciousness of humanity. It has stripped individuals of their agency, eroded their sense of self-worth, and relegated them to the margins of society. In this context, the quest for dignity becomes an act of defiance – a refusal to be defined by one's socioeconomic status, a declaration of inherent worthiness in the face of adversity.

Through these images, the viewer can find inspiration to confront the injustices that plague our world, and they are given the chance to reaffirm our shared humanity in the face of adversity. For in the quest for dignity, we find the essence of what it means to be truly human – resilient, compassionate, and inherently worthy of respect.

# Faces of Dignity

**The artist made a deliberate choice** to gradually abstract the imagery as the series progressed. This decision was driven by his desire to convey the increasingly complex and nuanced themes of poverty and human dignity in a visually compelling way.

At the outset, Gobber opted for a more representational approach, using elements of pop art and cubism to create vivid and recognizable portraits. This style allowed him to capture the essence of individual experiences and emotions, serving as a relatable entry point for viewers to engage with the artwork.

However, as the series evolved, he felt compelled to push the boundaries of representation and delve deeper into the underlying concepts of poverty and dignity. Gobber found that by abstracting the imagery, he could convey these themes in a more symbolic and universal manner, transcending the limitations of literal representation.

By stripping away unnecessary details and focusing more on the geometric shapes, bold colors, and expressive forms, he aimed to evoke a deeper emotional response and invite viewers to contemplate the broader implications of poverty and human dignity.

Additionally, abstraction allowed Gobber to highlight the interconnectedness of these themes with other social issues, such as inequality, injustice, and resilience. It enabled him to create visual metaphors and symbols that resonate across cultures and contexts, fostering a sense of empathy and solidarity among viewers.

Ultimately, his decision to illustrate the portraits in a progressively abstract manner was motivated by a desire to challenge conventional perceptions and stimulate meaningful dialogue about poverty and human dignity. He wanted to create artwork that not only captivates the eye but also sparks introspection and inspires action towards positive social change.



# Aspects of Dignity

## 1. Awakening:

The awakening of consciousness to both the challenges of poverty and the glory of our universal dignity.

## 2. Gates of Illumination:

Enlightenment, understanding, and growing awareness that poverty affects individuals from all walks of life. Many suffer in silence, in the shadows and only collective insight will be able to restore their dignity.

## 3. Dance of Differences:

Celebrating diversity and inclusivity, and working together, can create a more just and equitable society where everyone has the opportunity to thrive with dignity.

## 4. Denied Voice:

The silencing of marginalized voices affected by poverty and inequality. Without a platform, their dignity is not recognized or respected.

## 5. Keys to the Kingdom:

Knowledge is a powerful tool for empowerment and social change, because education and information can help individuals break free from the cycle of poverty and realize their full potential with dignity.

## 6. Interweaving Solidarity:

It speaks to the interconnectedness of humanity and the need for collective action to uphold the dignity of all individuals.

## 7. Heart of Labor:

It recognizes the inherent worth and value of every individual's labor, regardless of socioeconomic status. Dignified employment is essential for lifting people out of poverty for current and future generations.



# Aspects of Dignity

## 8. Line of Equality:

Addressing the inequalities that can harm human dignity. Poverty's negative impact on rights and opportunities creates social and psychological barriers.

## 9. Roots of Resilience:

This acknowledges the strength and perseverance of individuals and communities facing poverty, while maintaining their dignity and sense of self-worth.

## 10. Expansive Horizon:

The search for dignity can bring a brighter tomorrow filled with opportunity. The future is ours to envisage, there are always opportunities for growth and transformation.

## 11. Echoes of Justice:

The importance of holding institutions and individuals responsible for upholding human rights and ensuring that justice is served for those affected by poverty.

## 12. Seeds of Self:

Dignity is self-belief, the hope for a better future can be born through each person believing in and nurturing their destiny and worth despite barriers such as poverty.





AWAKENING



GATES OF ILLUMINATION



DANCE OF DIFFERENCES



DENIED VOICE



KEYS TO THE KINGDOM



INTERWEAVING SOLIDARITY



HEART OF LABOR



LELINE OF EQUALITY



ROOTS OF RESILIENCE



EXPANSIVE HORIZON



ECHOES OF JUSTICE



SEEDS OF SELF



# Shades of Resilience

In hues of pink and vibrant blue,  
A journey begins, anew.  
From faces formed in vivid light,  
To abstract shapes, a deeper sight.

Each stroke upon the canvas tells,  
Of poverty's grip, in silent spells.  
Yet through the colors, bold and bright,  
Dignity shines, a guiding light.

Awakening minds to truths untold,  
In dance of differences, we unfold.  
Denied voice finds echo in art's embrace,  
Seeds of knowledge, roots of grace.

Interwoven in solidarity's thread,  
Heart of labor, where hope is spread.  
Equality's line, resilience's root,  
In expansive horizons, dreams take root.

Echoes of justice, a call to rise,  
Seeds of hope beneath solemn skies.  
In this portrait of struggle and might,  
We find the essence of human plight.

Through abstract forms, our souls connect,  
In this gallery of pain and respect.  
For in each stroke, we find a plea,  
To defeat poverty, and set dignity free.



# Biography



Born in Trentino in 1979, Claudio Gobber grew up in the magnificent valleys of Primiero and Vanoi. Inspired by the work of Trentino and South Tyrolean artists from a young age, including Riccardo Schweizer, Simone Turra, and Giuliano Orsingher. He recognises himself as a sculptor, painter, photographer, and designer with a passion for new technologies.

While art has always been his Yin, business was his Yang. After a period of studying in Milan, where he obtained a bachelor's degree and a master's degree in Advertising, he moved to London, where he lived for 10 years. During his time in the city he was immersed in the world of photography, practicing the techniques his grandfather taught him as a young boy. This modern adventure was intersected by regular sessions in the mountain studio where he continued to paint and sculpt. Here Gobber balanced the frenzy of London by embracing the local woods that dominate the landscape near his family home.

After time in Switzerland and Spain, Gobber returned to Trentino where he continued to develop his paintings producing numerous acrylic works, and at this time, he developed an inclination towards creating clay sculptures. Indeed his art is strongly influenced by many different genres including digital works and NFTs emerging from the Crypto movement, and Gobber has a particular interest in the use of Generative Art software and VR platforms. He is fascinated with how physical art can be enhanced and re-interpreted in a digital space.

His artistic journey has encompassed both traditional techniques and digital experimentation, fuelled by curiosity. He aims to push the boundaries of his creativity, producing aesthetically positive and conceptually stimulating works. His intention is not to dictate beliefs, but rather to cultivate awareness of these crucial dialogues and inspire individuals to form their own considered viewpoints. Encouraging the audience to draw upon the wealth of knowledge at their disposal, to facilitate the development of meaningful and substantiated perspectives. This is as true for future generations as for current audiences, with his art serving as an anthropological time capsule for this rapidly changing society.

His art has been exhibited in various national and international shows, and his work has been well received by diverse audiences. He continues to nurture his passion for art and seek new ways to express his creativity.



# Further Information

## Art:

This project is comprised of 12 individual paintings

All paintings are made on canvas measuring 50cm x 50cm, using acrylic and finished with epoxy resin.

The pieces can be exhibited individually or can be grouped to form a large unique piece measuring 150cm x 200cm.

Each painting has a certificate of authenticity issued by [www.artrights.me](http://www.artrights.me) with a HASH on blockchain.

## Valuations details:

General artist valuation and critique issued by Vittorio Sgarbi 2023 "Annuario internazionale d'Arte contemporanea".

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